

Redwood Municipal Transit Operational Review: Fleet Maintenance Performance

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Executive Summary

This operational review assesses fleet maintenance performance across the Redwood Municipal Transit bus fleet for the six months from 1 July 2025 to 31 December 2025. The review was requested by the General Manager after on-time pull-out rates fell below the board standard in three consecutive months.

The review found that preventive maintenance inspections are frequently late, that parts deliveries from the primary parts vendor are slow, and that road call records are not consistently tied to work orders. As a result the backlog of deferred maintenance has grown to about \$860,000 and technician overtime has risen. The battery-electric buses introduced under the electrification program are performing well.

Four findings and three recommendations are presented. The Director of Maintenance has accepted the recommendations and has proposed the target dates listed in the Appendix.

Background

Redwood Municipal Transit operates 214 buses on 31 fixed routes and a paratransit service. All heavy maintenance is performed at the Cedar Street Maintenance Depot, a twelve-bay facility built in 1998. The depot runs two shifts and employs 46 technicians and service workers.

The Fleet Electrification Program is a five-year program to replace 60 diesel buses with battery-electric vehicles. Eighteen electric buses had entered service by the end of the review period, and charging equipment for a further 24 was under construction at the depot.

Road calls, pull-outs and vehicle assignments are recorded in the TransitTrack Dispatch System, which the agency licenses from a software provider. Replacement parts are supplied under a three-year contract by Pacific Coach Parts, the agency's primary parts vendor. The contract sets a ten-day delivery standard for stocked items.

The review team examined inspection records for all 214 buses, 1,320 parts orders and 610 road calls, and interviewed 19 maintenance and dispatch staff.

Findings

Finding 1: Preventive maintenance inspections at the Cedar Street Maintenance Depot were completed late on 38 percent of buses in the review period. Severity: High. The agency standard requires each inspection to be completed within 500 miles of its due mileage. Late inspections were most common on the articulated buses, where a single inspection occupies a bay for a full shift. Late inspections correlate with a 22 percent higher rate of road calls in the following month.

Finding 2: Parts orders placed with Pacific Coach Parts took an average of 19 days to arrive against a contracted 10 days. Severity: Medium. Of 1,320 orders, 740 arrived after the tenth day and 96 arrived after the thirtieth day. Buses waiting on parts accounted for an average of nine out-of-service vehicles each day. The agency has never applied the late delivery deductions available under the contract.

Finding 3: Road calls logged in the TransitTrack Dispatch System were not linked to work orders in 44 percent of cases. Severity: Medium. Without the link, the maintenance planners cannot tell which road calls were resolved by a repair and which were repeated failures of the same component. The review found 31 buses with three or more road calls for the same symptom and no corresponding repair record.

Finding 4: Battery-electric buses delivered under the Fleet Electrification Program achieved 94 percent availability, above the 90 percent target. Severity: Low. The electric buses required fewer unscheduled repairs per thousand miles than the diesel fleet. The review notes this as a positive result that supports the program schedule.

Recommendations

Recommendation 1: Reassign two technicians to a dedicated preventive maintenance crew at the Cedar Street Maintenance Depot. Priority: High. The crew should own the inspection schedule and report weekly on inspections completed within the mileage window.

Recommendation 2: Enforce the 10-day delivery term with Pacific Coach Parts through the late delivery deductions in the supply contract. Priority: Medium. The procurement office should issue a formal notice for the review period and apply deductions to all subsequent late deliveries.

Recommendation 3: Require dispatchers to attach a work order number to every road call recorded in the TransitTrack Dispatch System. Priority: Low. The system vendor has confirmed that the work order field can be made mandatory without additional licensing cost.

Financial Impact

The deferred maintenance backlog at the end of the review period is valued at \$680,000. The backlog consists of 112 open work orders for inspections, brake relines and cooling system repairs that have been postponed for lack of bay time or parts.

The Fleet Electrification Program budget for fiscal 2026 is \$2.3 million, of which \$1.4 million had been committed by the end of January. The program remains within budget and the review does not recommend any change to its funding.

Road call overtime paid to technicians during the review period amounted to USD 112,500. The review estimates that completing inspections on time would reduce road calls by roughly a fifth and cut overtime in proportion.

Appendix

Appendix A: Management response. Recommendation 1 is accepted with a target date of 31 March 2026. Recommendation 2 is accepted with a target date of 30 April 2026. Recommendation 3 is accepted with a target date of 15 March 2026. The Director of Maintenance is the responsible officer for all three.

Appendix B: Data sources. Inspection due dates and completion dates were taken from the fleet maintenance ledger. Parts order dates were taken from purchase order records and receiving logs. Road call data were exported from the TransitTrack Dispatch System for the full review period.

Appendix C: Distribution. This report is distributed to the General Manager, the Board Operations Committee and the Director of Maintenance.